Clinical guidelines are written for people to read, so checking whether a patient's care follows one still means someone reading the document by hand. We're building a system that turns guideline text into rules a computer can check a patient record against. Our system looks at a guideline and generates a list of rules that can be encoded in a computer fully, partially, or what cannot. Then, it is given patient data and, using a logic solver, it determines whether the guideline is followed or not.

In order to test whether our rule encoding test is accurate, we will check the machine output against doctor-labelled ones, so would like a doctor to label some statements from guidelines as fully accepted, partially accepted, or refused. A condition is a fact about the patient that the statement depends on (e.g. a laboratory value, a diagnosis, a medication, a procedure, or a timing requirement). A threshold is the value or boundary at which a condition becomes true: a number, a range, an interval, or a defined set.

Fully accepted: All conditions are checkable and all thresholds are specified. These can also be recommendations.
E.g. *"Blood cultures should be collected for acute cholangitis regardless of severity"*
"For adults with sepsis-induced moderate-severe ARDS, we recommend using prone ventilation for more than 12 h daily"
Reason: All conditions are checkable and all thresholds are specified.

Partially accepted. At least one condition is checkable and at least one is not.
E.g. *"Consider referral in high-risk patients with eGFR below 45"*
Reason: the eGFR threshold is specified; "high risk" is not defined.
E.g. *"For adults with sepsis or septic shock who require ICU admission, we suggest admitting the patients to the ICU within 6h"*
Reason: "require ICU admission" is not checkable as it does not have a score/quantitative measure.

Refused. No condition in the statement is checkable against a record, either because no condition in it is checkable or because the statement is not about a patient at all. The latter includes statements addressed to the reader of the guideline, descriptions of how the guideline was developed, and service- or process-level requirements.
E.g. *"Recommendation: In adults and children with suspected intra-abdominal infections who have an elevated temperature AND hypotension and/or tachypnea and/or delirium, OR there is concern for antibiotic-resistant organisms that would inform the treatment"*
Reason: refused because no action was given, so there is nothing to encode.

I’ve sent the list of 48 statements (as a Google Sheets file) that we ask you to label as fully acceptable, partially acceptable, or refused. We estimate that it wouldn’t take more than an hour, but if it is taking too long, any amount that you can label is great!